

Lightning Talk Abstract for HCOMP & CI 2026 Workshop
Past Meets Future #3

Matthew J. Westerby (<https://orcid.org/0000-0003-0903-8200>)

What, when, and where is AI? A Workshop and Discussion Group for Researchers

To broaden how researchers in the humanities and visual arts think about and use AI as a technology, a workshop series and discussion group at the National Gallery of Art will ask: *what*, *when*, and *where* is AI? Building on a preliminary 2025 discussion series designed for fellows and staff at the National Gallery of Art's Center for Advanced Studies in the Visual Arts, a second iteration will expand the number of participants and organize meetings around short demos and workshops in addition to short readings that critique AI in research, teaching, and cultural heritage/GLAM. The mild absurdity of asking the *what*, *when*, and *where* of "AI" is intended to open a critique of the overly broad application of the term, which can often be substituted for "computation."¹ In my lightning talk, I will briefly share some lessons learned and enduring questions from the preliminary series, and goals for the second iteration for the 2026 academic year.

Topics that will center our demos and discussions include:

- What is hallucination?
- When does AI "see" the world in ways that humans cannot?
- What are small models and where do they run?
- What is materiality to a language machine?
- What happens with AI translates *everything*?
- What does Wikipedia have to do with AI?
- When was AI art?
- What does "vibe coding" mean for digital collections?

¹ Emily Pugh, "How to AI: Stop Talking about 'AI,'" *Electric Toaster* (18 July 2026).
<https://electrictoaster.substack.com/p/how-to-ai-stop-talking-about-ai>